

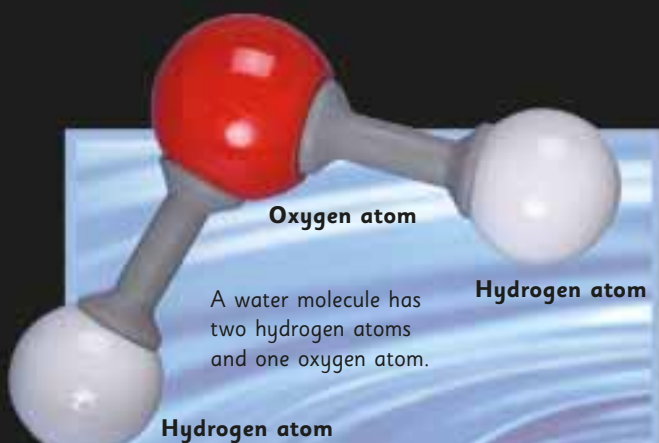
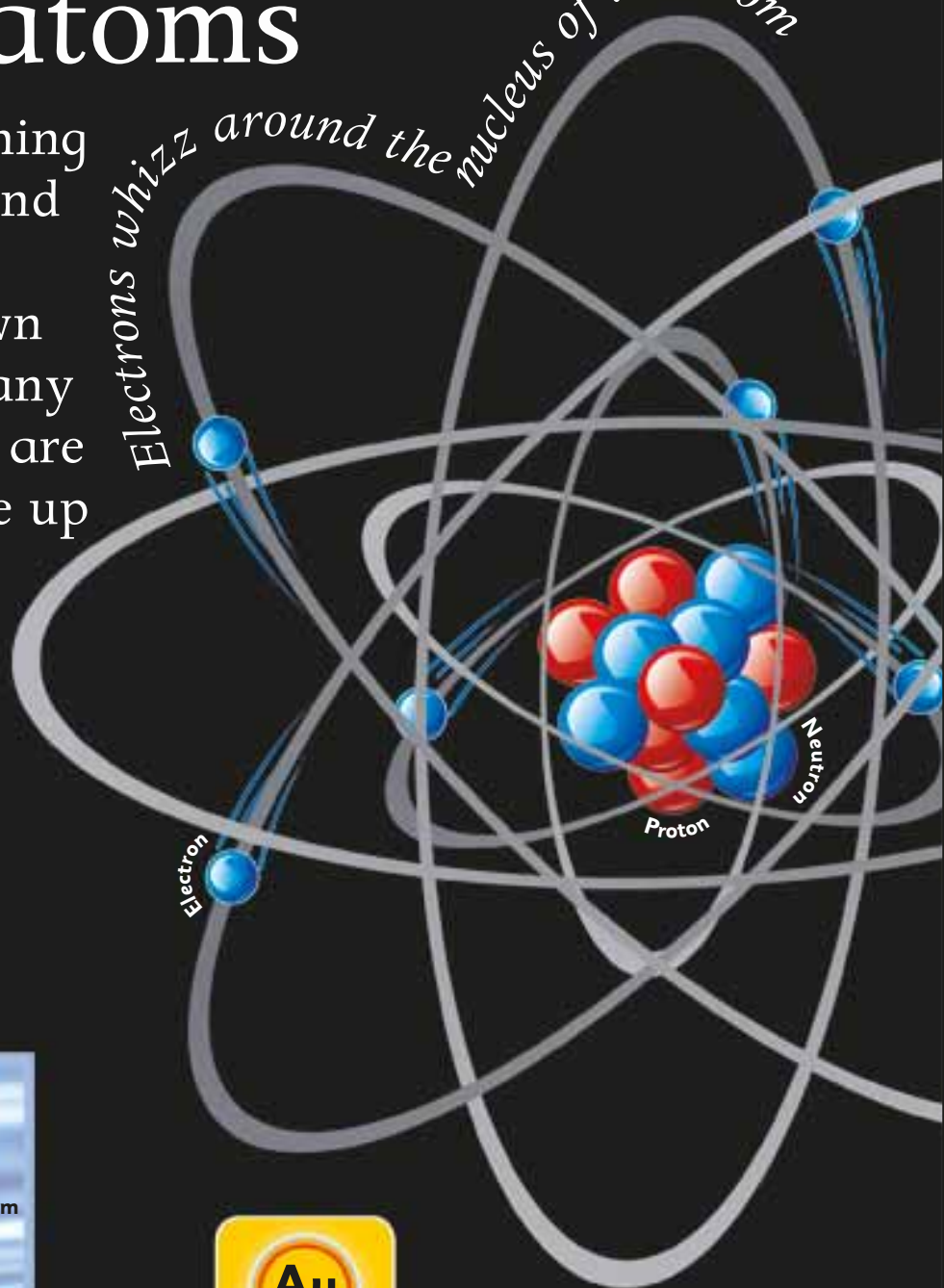
Amazing atoms

If you could keep smashing an object into smaller and smaller bits, you would eventually break it down into bits that can't get any smaller – atoms. Atoms are tiny particles that make up everything around us.

Inside an atom

Inside an atom are three tiny types of particle: protons, neutrons, and electrons. Protons and neutrons make up the atom's nucleus (core). The electrons are outside this.

Electrons whizz around the nucleus of the atom



Molecules

Substances are made from little groups of atoms called molecules. The molecules in water have three atoms.



Golden number

The number of protons in an atom is called its atomic number. The atomic number of gold is 79. This means that each gold atom has 79 protons.